



"No Kidding",
June 25, 2007

"The cover story is thought provoking. It only shows that today's youngsters are imitating heroes and heroines of films and television shows."

W.K.S. RAMAN, *Chennai*

Too Young to be Old

With disposable incomes growing, it is not surprising that today's adolescents are availing various beauty treatments at such a tender age ("No Kidding", June 25). Parents should take steps to discourage this trend, which is making their children adults before their time and will have repercussions later in life.

NANDINI SANYAL, *Delhi*

There is nothing wrong with the desire to look and feel good. But what is disturbing is the fact that it is growing into an obsession for today's youngsters. Instead of focussing on studies and games, most of them are today devoting their time to looking good and maintaining their figure.

CHETAN PRABHAKAR, *Gurgaon*

Your cover story deals with a very frivolous topic. Kids

hitting beauty parlours and gymnasiums is still not very common among middle-class families. It's unfair to project something that happens in the highest stratum of society as an overall trend.

R. RAMJI, *Chennai*

Today's society is largely driven by what children want. If they are given the onus to decide, it's obvious they'll choose wrong over right. For proper upbringing, parents should take a stand and decide what is right and wrong, even if it is against the wishes of their children. Children should learn to take "a no for an answer".

S. LAKSHMI, *on e-mail*

Pictures of children going for spa treatments, manicures and pedicures will only add fuel to the fire. More and more teenagers would want to avail such services. Where is the hurry to

grow up? Childhood should never be sacrificed for fame or money.

R.D. SINGH, *Jammu*

Power Less

It is a pity that India, after six decades of Independence, is still a power deficit country ("Blacked Out", June 25). Power theft has to be rigorously checked. Strong measures have to be taken to plug leakage and enhance electricity generation.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
Dehradun

It's a shame that 14 years of power reforms haven't solved India's electricity crisis. It only shows our demand for energy has far outstripped the availability. Instead of focussing on FDI and GDP growth, the government should first take steps to ensure that common people get adequate power supply.

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Act and Grace

Apart from her acting prowess, Tabu has an expressive and intelligent, face ("A Singular Star", June 25). She has had a long innings in the film industry, spanning over 19 years, yet her enamouring charm seems to be rising by the day. Her expressions depict an unfathomable depth of intense living. She has fortified her position with her new releases.

SANTULAN MAHANTA,
Jorhat, Assam

Taxing the Brain

It is heartening to know that income tax return forms have been simplified ("Bye Bye Saral, Hello Clarity", June 25). But when will our complex tax laws be made simpler? At present, even qualified chartered accountants find it difficult to explain the fundamentals of the tax laws.

SANTOSH SINGH, *on e-mail*